GRADE 4 INFORMATIONAL READING ASSESSMENT: LEARNING TO PREPARE FOOD

AT A GLANCE:

- GRADE 4
- ORIGINAL INFORMATIONAL PASSAGE
- FOCUS STANDARD | RI.4.2
- TASK | READ ONE INFORMATIONAL PASSAGE AND ANSWER 8 SELECTED MC QUESTIONS
- SUGGESTED TIME | 20-25 MINUTES

SHOWCASES: STANDARDS ALIGNMENT, ITEM WRITING, DISTRACTOR RATIONALE, ASSESSMENT DESIGN

MATERIALS:

- TEACHER/EDITOR ASSESSMENT DESIGN NOTES & ANSWER KEY (PDF)
- STUDENT ASSESSMENT (PDF)
- PENCILOPTIONAL: HIGHLIGHTER OR ANNOTATION TOOL

OBJECTIVES:

BY THE END OF THIS ASSESSMENT, STUDENTS WILL BE ABLE TO:

- DETERMINE THE MAIN IDEA OF AN INFORMATIONAL TEXT.
- IDENTIFY KEY DETAILS THAT SUPPORT THE MAIN IDEA.
- SELECT RELEVANT DETAILS FOR A SUMMARY.

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Assessment Rationale

Passage design

- The original passage presents food preparation as a set of adult-guided, safe activities.
- Its organization develops three connected benefits: learning about food and safety, practicing thinking skills, and building confidence/community connections.
- Paragraph 5 returns to safe adult guidance, reinforcing that children can participate without using equipment independently.

Assessment design

- Items move from an accessible supporting detail to the whole-text main idea, then return to paragraph-based evidence and summary decisions.
- The eight items sample the full **RI.4.2 construct:** main idea, supporting details, explanation of support, paragraph summary, and selection of important details for a whole-text summary. **Click here to view the RI.4.2 Standard.**
- Options include a correct response and three plausible distractors based on narrow-but-true details, details from another paragraph, overgeneralizations, or reversals of the text's meaning. Strong multiple-choice options should be parallel and based on believable misunderstandings.

Item Analysis Table

Item	Skill and Evidence	Correct Answer	Rationale	Distractor Rationale
1	Supporting detail; Paragraph 1	**A**	Washing fruits and vegetables is a safe, adult-guided job named in paragraph 1. It supports the idea that food preparation can help children learn about food.	**B:** True detail from paragraph 2; it does not answer about paragraph 1. **C:** True detail from paragraph 4; it does not answer about paragraph 1. **D:** True detail from paragraph 3; it does not answer about paragraph 1.
2	Whole-text main idea	**B**	The passage explains that food preparation helps children gain knowledge, thinking skills, and confidence.	**A:** Safety is an important supporting idea, but it is too narrow for the whole passage. **C:** Food choices are one benefit, but this option leaves out thinking skills and confidence. **D:** Traditions are one benefit, but this option leaves out the passage's other central ideas.
3	Supporting detail; Paragraph 2	**A**	Paragraph 2 explains that foods come in many colors, flavors, and forms.	**B:** Changes the ingredients in the passage's salad example. **C:** Reverses the passage's meaning; touching ingredients can make new foods feel more familiar, not less familiar. **D:** A true detail from paragraph 4, not paragraph 2.

Item	Skill and Evidence	Correct Answer	Rationale	Distractor Rationale
4	Explaining support; Paragraph 3	**A**	Reading directions, measuring, planning, and problem solving show that food preparation develops thinking skills.	**B:** Refers to traditions, which are developed in paragraph 4. **C:** Overgeneralizes one example about changing recipe amounts. **D:** Reduces the paragraph's several thinking skills to measuring alone.
5	Paragraph summary; Paragraph 3	**A**	This choice states the paragraph's broad idea and includes representative skills.	**B:** Focuses too narrowly on one skill. **C:** Incorrectly says the paragraph is only about changing ingredient amounts. **D:** Uses information from paragraph 4 instead of paragraph 3.
6	Supporting detail; Paragraph 4	**A**	The passage connects confidence to contributing to food preparation and seeing a useful result.	**B:** Omits the important idea of seeing the result of one's work. **C:** Confuses learning about traditions with gaining confidence. **D:** Incorrectly says that children must prepare a meal independently to gain confidence.
7	Explaining support; Paragraph 5	**A**	Adult guidance makes safe participation possible through appropriate tasks and supervision.	**B:** Overstates the equipment children may use safely. **C:** A true idea about traditions, but it does not explain why adult guidance matters for safety.

Item	Skill and Evidence	Correct Answer	Rationale	Distractor Rationale
				D: Overgeneralizes by suggesting children should not participate until they can use every kitchen tool.
8	Selecting relevant details; Whole passage	**A**	The exact salad ingredients are an illustrative example rather than a central idea for a whole-text summary.	**B:** Thinking skills are a central benefit of food preparation. **C:** Confidence is a central benefit of food preparation. **D:** Adult guidance and safety are central ideas in the passage.

Use and Scoring Notes

Administration

- Give students access to the complete passage while they answer.
- Read the directions aloud if that support is routinely available.
- Encourage students to return to the text and use paragraph and line labels to locate evidence.
- Do not read the passage or answer options aloud unless that accommodation is specified in a student plan.

Scoring

- Award **1 point** for each correct selected-response item.
- **Total score: 8 points.**
- Suggested interpretation
    - **7–8** demonstrates secure performance
    - **5–6** demonstrates developing performance
    - **0–4** indicates the student may benefit from more instruction and guided practice with main idea, supporting details, and summary.

Accessibility and fairness

- The passage is original and uses a familiar, culturally flexible topic.
- Paragraph labels and line numbers support navigation and text-evidence routines.
- The assessment does not require students to have prior cooking experience; all answers are available in the passage.
- Use standard classroom accommodations as appropriate, without changing the skill assessed.

Credits

- **Original assessment design and items:** Carmen Khoury, 2026.
- **Reading passage:** Created with AI assistance and reviewed, revised, and finalized by Carmen Khoury, 2026.